
THE BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO

Caravan Solar

Clear recommendations, brand comparisons, and shopping lists for Australian caravanners who don't want to become electrical engineers.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Your power audit in 10 minutes
- Exactly what to buy, component by component
- Brand comparisons (REDARC, Victron, Enerdrive, Renogy)
- Ready-to-use shopping lists for your tier
- Printable checklists and worksheets

Sized for how you travel:

Weekender

Tourer

Full-timer

Contents

- 01 The 60-Second Version**
Everything you need to know in one page

- 02 Your Power Audit**
Figure out how much power you actually use

- 03 What to Buy**
Component by component, plain English

- 04 Brand Comparisons & Shopping Lists**
Side-by-side picks with ready-to-use lists

- 05 System Sizing Check**
Make sure the numbers actually work

- 06 Expensive Mistakes**
7 mistakes that cost \$500 to \$2,000

Checklists & Worksheets

Before You Buy, Installer Brief, First Week

LOOK FOR THESE BOXES

SKIP TO THIS

Every section has a callout box like this one. Read only these boxes and you'll have your answer in about 5 minutes.

The 60-Second Version

SKIP THIS IF YOU WANT

SKIP TO THIS

Just want the "what to buy" part? Go straight to Section 3. Otherwise, here's the 60-second version.

The Whole System in Plain English

1. Solar panels sit on your roof and turn sunlight into power.
2. A battery stores that power. This is the fuel tank.
3. A charge controller manages charging safely.
4. A DC-DC charger tops up the battery from your car while you drive.
5. An inverter lets you plug in normal 240V things (laptop, microwave).
6. A battery monitor is your fuel gauge.

That's it. Six things. The rest of this guide tells you exactly which ones to buy and what size.

One Quick Concept

Watt-hours measure daily power use. If something uses 60 watts for 10 hours, that's 600 Wh. Your fridge uses about 60W all day: roughly 1,440 Wh.

That daily number drives everything: battery size, solar, the lot. Section 2 helps you work out yours in about 10 minutes.

Your Power Audit

We need to figure out roughly how much power your caravan uses in a day. Takes about 10 minutes, and it's the one piece of homework in this guide. Everything else flows from it.

Don't stress about being exact. Within 20% is plenty. We add a buffer for the stuff you forget.

Walk-Through: Dave and Sarah's Setup

Dave and Sarah are tourers. Weeks on the road, mix of parks and free camping. Here's their typical day off-grid:

Appliance	Usage	Daily Wh
Fridge (all day, all night)	60W x 24h	~1,440 Wh
LED lights (evening)	30W x 5h	~150 Wh
TV after dinner	40W x 3h	~120 Wh
Phones + laptop	100W x 2h	~220 Wh
Water pump, heater, etc.	Various	~220 Wh

Daily total: about 2,150 Wh. Add 25% buffer: about 2,700 Wh per day.

That's it. No complicated formulas. Just: what do you have, how long is it on, roughly how much does it use?

Your turn. Use the Power Audit Worksheet at the back. It lists every common caravan appliance with typical power draws.

Which Tier Are You?

Your daily number tells you what kind of system you need:

WEEKENDER

\$1,500 - \$2,500

Under 1,500 Wh/day

Short trips, mostly caravan parks, some free camping. Fridge, lights, phones.

TOURER

\$3,000 - \$5,000

1,500 to 3,000 Wh/day

Weeks on the road, mix of parks and free camping. Fridge, lights, TV, laptops.

FULL-TIMER

\$5,000 - \$8,000+

Over 3,000 Wh/day

Living on the road. Everything above plus microwave, coffee machine, hair dryer.

A NOTE ON AIR CONDITIONING

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Air con off-grid isn't practical on a standard setup. If it's a must-have, you need a 48V system (\$10,000+) or a generator. This guide covers standard 12V setups.

Got your number? Good. From here on, the guide is built around your tier. Every recommendation, every shopping list is matched to Weekender, Tourer, or Full-timer.

What to Buy

Each component gets a quick answer at the top. Trust us? Read the callout boxes and move on.

Battery

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Buy lithium. Not AGM, not gel. Lithium. Costs more upfront but lasts years longer and gives way more usable power. 200Ah lithium is the sweet spot for most people.

An AGM "200Ah" battery only gives about 100Ah usable. A lithium "200Ah" gives 160-200Ah usable. You'd need two AGMs to match one lithium, and they weigh twice as much and last 3-5 years vs 10+.

The most common beginner mistake is buying AGM now and upgrading to lithium a year later. That's \$400-\$800 in the bin.

What to buy by tier:

- Weekender: 100-200Ah lithium
- Tourer: 200Ah lithium (one battery does the job)
- Full-timer: 300-400Ah lithium

Make sure it has a built-in BMS (Battery Management System). All the brands we recommend include one.

Solar Panels

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Fixed panels on the roof PLUS a portable folding panel. Roof panels do daily work; portable is for shade. Go monocrystalline.

Fixed panels bolt to your roof and work all day. Portable panels fold out at camp and angle toward the sun. Most people get both.

A "400W" panel produces 200-280W in real conditions. This guide's sizing accounts for that.

By tier:

- Weekender: 200W fixed
- Tourer: 300-400W fixed + 160-200W portable
- Full-timer: 400-600W fixed + 200W+ portable

Charge Controller

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Under 200W solar: PWM is fine. Everyone else: get MPPT. It squeezes 15-30% more power. Size at about 1/3 of your solar wattage in amps.

By tier:

- Weekender: 20A PWM or MPPT
- Tourer: 30-40A MPPT
- Full-timer: 40-50A MPPT

DC-DC Charger

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Charges your battery from the car while you drive.
Not optional. A few hours of driving puts a big chunk back in. Buy a REDARC BCDC.

Modern cars have smart alternators that don't work with a direct connection. A DC-DC charger sorts this out. A 40A unit gives 120-160Ah on a 3-4 hour drive.

By tier:

- Weekender: 20A DC-DC charger
- Tourer: 40A DC-DC charger
- Full-timer: 40-60A DC-DC charger

Inverter

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Pure sine wave inverter. NEVER modified sine wave.
Size for your biggest appliance. Weekender: 1000W.
Tourer: 2000W. Full-timer: 3000W.

Your battery is 12V, appliances need 240V. The inverter converts it. Always pure sine wave. Modified sine wave saves \$50-\$100 but damages laptops and chargers.

How big? Biggest single appliance: phones and laptops = 1000W. Microwave = 2000W. Hair dryer = 3000W.

Battery Monitor

BOTTOM LINE

SKIP TO THIS

Buy a Victron SmartShunt (\$130-\$160). Shows battery level on your phone via Bluetooth. Without a monitor, you're driving without a fuel gauge.

It shows exactly what percentage you're at, how fast you're using power, and how long until full. Without it you'll wear out the battery without realising.

Your Complete System at a Glance

All six components. Find your tier:

Component	Weekender	Tourer	Full-timer
Battery	100-200Ah	200Ah	300-400Ah
Solar (roof)	200W	300-400W	400-600W
Solar (portable)	Optional	160-200W	200W+
Controller	20A PWM/MPPT	30-40A MPPT	40-50A MPPT
DC-DC charger	20A	40A	40-60A
Inverter	1000W PSW	2000W PSW	3000W PSW
Monitor	SmartShunt	SmartShunt	SmartShunt

That's your whole setup. Six things, sized for how you travel. Next section turns this into a shopping list with specific brands and prices.

Which Brands to Buy

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

REDARC for DC-DC chargers. Victron for monitoring.
Enerdrive for value. Renogy if budget is tight.
Mixing brands is fine.

This guide isn't sponsored by or affiliated with any brand.
Genuine recommendations based on what holds up.

REDARC

[The Safe Choice](#)

Australian-made, based in Adelaide. Premium price, excellent build quality. Their BCDC DC-DC charger range is the industry standard.

Buy REDARC for: DC-DC chargers. Think twice for: monitoring (Victron's app is better), and if budget is tight.

Victron

[The Smart Choice](#)

Dutch company, since 1975. Best app in the business. Battery level on your phone, graphs, alerts. Victron's ecosystem is in a league of its own.

Buy Victron for: charge controllers, battery monitors, inverters. Think twice for: more separate components than REDARC or Enerdrive.

Enerdrive

The Value Choice

Australian brand (now Dometic). Good quality at lower price than REDARC, 5-year warranty, lifetime tech support. Their eSystem pre-wired boards are close to plug-and-play.

Buy for: batteries, inverters, pre-wired systems. Think twice: narrower product range.

Renogy

The Budget Choice

Chinese brand with AU warehouse. Significantly cheaper. A 200Ah lithium for under \$500 vs \$800+ elsewhere. Good for Weekenders on a tight budget.

Buy for: panels, batteries, starter kits. Think twice: full-timer daily reliance, slower warranty support.

One-Page Comparison

	REDARC	Victron	Enerdrive	Renogy
Made in	Australia	Netherlands	AU (Dometic)	China
Price	Premium	Premium	Mid-range	Budget
Best at	DC-DC	App + monitor	Value + install	Price
Warranty	2 years	5 years	5yr + lifetime	5 years
App	Good	Excellent	Good	Basic
AU support	Excellent	Good	Excellent	OK

Mixing Brands

You don't have to buy from one brand. Mix and match:
REDARC DC-DC, Victron monitoring, Enerdrive battery.
Standard connections, not proprietary.

Where to Buy in Australia

- Solar 4 RVs, Caravan RV Camping, My Generator (specialist retailers)
- REDARC, Enerdrive, Renogy sell direct. Victron via distributors.
- Jaycar for cables, fuses, and small bits.

Avoid no-name brands on eBay/Amazon with no Australian warranty.

DON'T FORGET THE SMALL BITS

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Everyone forgets cables, fuses, Anderson plugs, and mounting brackets. Budget \$100-\$400. The Shopping List Worksheet has a full checklist.

WEEKENDER SHOPPING LIST

\$1,500 - \$2,500

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	Renogy/Enerdrive 200Ah Li	\$480-\$900
Solar (roof)	1x 200W monocrystalline	\$200-\$350
Controller	20A MPPT (Renogy/Victron)	\$100-\$200
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1220 (20A)	\$200-\$400
Inverter	1000W pure sine wave	\$150-\$300
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt	\$130-\$160
Wiring + bits	Cable, fuses, Anderson	\$100-\$200

Shopping Lists

TOURER SHOPPING LIST

\$3,000 - \$5,000

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	200-300Ah Li (Enerdrive/Victron)	\$900-\$1,800
Solar (roof)	2x 200W monocrystalline	\$400-\$700
Solar (portable)	1x 160-200W folding	\$300-\$500
Controller	30-40A MPPT (Victron)	\$200-\$400
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1240 (40A)	\$400-\$600
Inverter	2000W PSW (Enerdrive/Victron)	\$350-\$600
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt	\$130-\$160
Wiring + bits	Cable, fuses, Anderson, ext socket	\$150-\$300

FULL-TIMER SHOPPING LIST

\$5,000 - \$8,000+

What	Buy This	Cost
Battery	300-400Ah Li (Victron/Enerdrive)	\$1,800-\$3,000
Solar (roof)	400-600W (2-3 panels)	\$600-\$1,200
Solar (portable)	1x 200W+ folding	\$400-\$700
Controller	40-50A MPPT (Victron)	\$300-\$500
DC-DC charger	REDARC BCDC1250D (50A)	\$500-\$800
Inverter	3000W PSW (Victron/Enerdrive)	\$800-\$1,500
Monitor	Victron SmartShunt/BMV-712	\$130-\$300
Wiring + bits	Heavy cable, fuses, dist. board	\$200-\$400

Checking Your Sizing

BOTTOM LINE

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Buying from the shopping lists in Section 4? Sizing is already done. This is a double-check, or for setups between tiers.

The Quick Sanity Check

Run these three checks. If all pass, you're good to go.

CHECK 1

Solar vs Battery

Solar watts should be 1.5-2x your battery Ah. E.g. 200Ah battery = 300-400W solar.

CHECK 2

Controller vs Solar

Controller amps should be about 1/3 of solar watts. E.g. 400W solar = 30-40A controller.

CHECK 3

Inverter vs Biggest Appliance

Inverter should be 2x your biggest appliance. E.g. 1000W microwave = 2000W inverter.

All three checks pass? You're done. Go buy it.

Worked Example: Dave and Sarah

Daily use: 2,700 Wh (with 25% buffer). Tourers who drive regularly.

Battery: $2,700 \text{ Wh} / 12\text{V} = 225\text{Ah}$ minimum. With cloudy-day buffer: 400Ah total (2x 200Ah lithium).

Solar: $2,700 / 5.5\text{h} / 0.65 = \sim 760\text{W}$ needed, but DC-DC helps on driving days. 400W roof + 200W portable (600W total).

Controller: $400\text{W} / 12\text{V} \times 1.25 = 42\text{A}$. They buy a 50A MPPT.

DC-DC: 40A charger gives $\sim 160\text{Ah}$ on a 4-hour drive.

Inverter: Biggest appliance is 1000W microwave. 2000W pure sine wave.

Dave and Sarah's Final System

Component	What They Bought
Battery	2x 200Ah lithium (400Ah total)
Solar (roof)	2x 200W panels (400W)
Solar (portable)	1x 200W folding panel
Charge controller	50A MPPT
DC-DC charger	40A
Inverter	2000W pure sine wave
Battery monitor	Victron SmartShunt
Total cost	~\$4,500 - \$5,500

Sun Hours by Region

If you're doing the longer sizing calculation, here are average daily peak sun hours across Australia:

Region	Good	Poor	Avg
Northern AU (Darwin, Cairns)	5.5-6.5	5.0-6.0	5.5-6.0
Central AU (Alice Springs)	6.5-7.5	5.0-5.5	6.0-6.5
Eastern (Sydney, Melbourne)	5.5-6.5	3.0-3.5	4.5-5.0
Western AU (Perth, Pilbara)	6.0-7.0	3.5-4.0	5.0-5.5
South AU (Adelaide, Flinders)	6.0-7.0	3.5-4.0	5.0-5.5
Tasmania	5.0-5.5	2.5-3.0	3.5-4.0

If you travel up north in winter (like most caravanners do), you get excellent sun year-round. Staying in the southeast through winter means less output. Worth sizing up slightly if that's the plan.

Use the System Sizing Worksheet at the back to run through these calculations with your own numbers.

Expensive Mistakes

If you've followed this guide, you've already avoided all of these. Read through anyway.

Mistake 1: Buying AGM Now, Lithium Later

\$400-\$800 wasted

You buy AGM because it's cheaper upfront. Within a year you upgrade to lithium. The AGMs go in the bin. Buy lithium from the start.

Mistake 2: Not Enough Solar for Your Battery

\$300-\$1,000+

Big battery, not enough solar. It sits undercharged day after day, wearing out years early. Solar should be 1.5-2x your battery Ah.

Mistake 3: Trusting the Number on the Box

\$500-\$1,500

Your "400W" panels produce 200-280W in real conditions. People who don't know this buy too little and wonder why the battery never fills.

Mistake 4: Thin Cables

\$200-\$500 to rewire

12V systems need thicker cables than house wiring. Thin cables waste power. Going DIY? One size thicker than you think you need.

Mistake 5: No Battery Monitor

\$500-\$1,500

Without a monitor, you guess how much charge is left. You run it down too far, it wears out faster. A SmartShunt costs \$130-\$160.

Mistake 6: Modified Sine Wave Inverter

\$200-\$500

You save \$50-\$100 on a cheaper inverter that produces rough power. Laptops and chargers stop working properly. Always buy pure sine wave.

Mistake 7: No External Anderson Plug

\$300-\$500 wasted

You buy a portable panel but there's nowhere to plug it in outside. An external Anderson socket costs \$20-\$40 and takes 30 minutes to install.

The Pattern

Every mistake comes from one of three places:

- Buying cheap and replacing later. The right gear once is cheaper than the wrong gear twice.
- Not knowing real-world performance. Lab specs differ from reality. This guide accounts for that.
- Skipping the small stuff. Cables, monitors, and Anderson plugs are cheap. The problems they prevent aren't.

If you bought from the shopping lists in Section 4, you've avoided all seven.

Before You Buy

THE BASICS

- ☐ Completed the Power Audit (Section 2 or worksheet)
- ☐ Know your daily watt-hours number
- ☐ Identified your tier: Weekender / Tourer / Full-timer

YOUR GEAR

- ☐ Shopping List worksheet filled in with specific products
- ☐ Battery is lithium with built-in BMS
- ☐ Inverter is pure sine wave
- ☐ Battery monitor included (e.g. Victron SmartShunt)
- ☐ External Anderson plug socket included
- ☐ Cables, fuses, and connectors in your budget

WILL IT FIT?

- ☐ Measured roof space for panels (clear of A/C, antenna, hatches)
- ☐ Checked battery box dimensions
- ☐ Confirmed weight (lithium is usually lighter than AGM)

QUICK SIZING CHECK

- ☐ Solar watts = 1.5-2x battery Ah?
- ☐ Controller amps = $\sim 1/3$ of solar watts?
- ☐ Inverter handles biggest appliance with room to spare?

INSTALLATION

- ☐ Got an installer? Hand them the Installer Brief.
- ☐ Going DIY? Grab manufacturer install guides for each component.

What to Tell Your Installer

Print this page and hand it to your installer.

My System Specs

Component	What I Want
Battery	_____ Ah lithium (Brand: _____)
Solar (roof)	_____ W total (___ x ___ W panels)
Portable panel	_____ W (with ext. Anderson socket)
Charge controller	_____ A MPPT (Brand: _____)
DC-DC charger	_____ A (Brand: _____)
Inverter	_____ W pure sine wave (Brand: _____)
Battery monitor	Brand: _____

PLEASE MAKE SURE

- ☐ External Anderson plug socket is installed for portable panel
- ☐ Battery monitor is set up and working before you leave
- ☐ All wiring is correctly sized for the system
- ☐ I get a walk-through of the system when done (see next page)

Questions to Ask

1. "Have you installed this brand/setup before?"
2. "Is there anything in my spec list you'd change, and why?"
3. "What's included in the quote and what's extra?"
4. "How long will it take?" (standard tourer = ~1 day)
5. "What warranty do I get on the installation work?"

After Installation Walk-Through

Before the installer leaves, get them to show you:

- ☐ How to read the battery monitor (percentage, charging)
- ☐ Where the main fuse/isolator is
- ☐ How to connect the portable panel via Anderson plug
- ☐ System is working: solar charging, battery level going up
- ☐ Test a 240V appliance through the inverter
- ☐ Their contact number for roadside issues

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Installers are busy. Walk in with just "I want solar" and you'll get whatever they normally install. This page makes sure you get what you planned for.

Your First Week With Solar

Your system is in. Here's how to get familiar with it.
After a week it'll be second nature.

Day 1: Get to Know Your Monitor

- ☐ Find the battery monitor. Should show a percentage.
- ☐ Turn on your usual stuff (fridge, lights). Watch the monitor.
- ☐ Test the inverter. Phone charger first, then biggest appliance.
- ☐ Plug in portable panel via Anderson socket. Confirm charging.

Day 2-3: Learn the Pattern

- ☐ Check monitor in the morning. 100% to 85% overnight is normal.
- ☐ Check late afternoon. Back near 95-100%? System is keeping up.
- ☐ Notice the rhythm: drops overnight, fills during the day.

THE DAILY RHYTHM

[SKIP TO THIS](#)

Battery drops overnight (fridge), solar fills it during the day. If the top-up roughly matches drawdown, you're golden. Hovering around 80% by afternoon? Set up the portable panel.

What You'll See (All Normal)

- Battery sits between 70-100% on a typical day
- Solar output is high midday, low morning/evening, zero at night
- Fridge draws power in bursts (compressor cycling on/off)
- Inverter hums quietly when switched on
- Cloudy days produce less solar (1-2 cloudy days is fine)

If Something Seems Off

Battery dropping even though it's sunny?

Check for shade on panels. Move the van or set up portable panel.

Inverter switches off when you plug something in?

Too much at once. Use one big appliance at a time.

Battery low after a few overcast days?

Drive for a couple of hours. The DC-DC charger will handle it.

After a Week

You'll barely think about it. A quick glance at the monitor becomes like checking the fuel gauge. If it stays above 60-70% most of the time, your system is well sized.

That's it. You've got solar on your caravan and you know how to use it.

Power Audit

List every electrical appliance you plan to run off-grid. Check the label for wattage. If it shows amps, multiply by 12 to get watts.

Appliance	Watts	Hrs/Day	Daily Wh
Compressor fridge	50-70	24	_____
LED lights (all)	20-40	_____	_____
TV (12V)	30-60	_____	_____
Phone charger x ____	10-20 ea	_____	_____
Laptop charger	45-65	_____	_____
Tablet charger	10-15	_____	_____
Water pump	50-70	_____	_____
Diesel heater fan	20-40	_____	_____
Range hood fan	20-30	_____	_____
Radio/speakers	10-20	_____	_____
CPAP machine	30-60	_____	_____
Electric blanket	40-60	_____	_____

Power Audit Worksheet

Appliance	Watts	Hrs/Day	Daily Wh
Hair dryer (inverter)	1200-2000	----	-----
Microwave (inverter)	800-1200	----	-----
Coffee machine (inv.)	800-1500	----	-----
Toaster (inverter)	800-1200	----	-----
-----	-----	----	-----
-----	-----	----	-----
-----	-----	----	-----

Subtotal:

----- Wh

+ 25% buffer (x 1.25):

----- Wh

Your Traveller Tier

Under 1,500 Wh
Weekender

1,500-3,000 Wh
Tourer

Over 3,000 Wh
Full-timer

My tier: -----

My daily total: ----- Wh

System Sizing

Daily power use (from Power Audit):

_____ Wh

STEP 1

Battery Size

Daily Wh / 12V / 0.85 (lithium usable) = minimum Ah

_____ Wh / 12 / 0.85 = _____ Ah (minimum)

_____ Ah x 1.5 = _____ Ah (with 1 day reserve)

Your battery choice: _____ Ah lithium

STEP 2

Solar Panel Wattage

Daily Wh / peak sun hours / 0.65 (real-world efficiency) = total solar watts

_____ Wh / _____ hours / 0.65 = _____ W

Fixed panels: _____ W

Portable: _____ W

STEP 3

Charge Controller Size

Fixed panel wattage / 12V x 1.25 (safety margin) = controller amps

_____ W / 12 x 1.25 = _____ A

Your charge controller: _____ A MPPT

System Sizing Worksheet

STEP 4

Inverter Size

Add up 240V appliances you'd run simultaneously, multiply by 1.2 for surge.

Total simultaneous: _____ W x 1.2 = _____ W

Your inverter: _____ W pure sine wave

STEP 5

DC-DC Charger

Weekender: 20A. Tourer: 40A. Full-timer: 40-60A.

Your DC-DC charger: _____ A

Complete System Summary

Component	Spec	Brand/Model	Est. Cost
Battery	___Ah Li	_____	\$_____
Solar (fixed)	___W	_____	\$_____
Solar (portable)	___W	_____	\$_____
Controller	___A MPPT	_____	\$_____
DC-DC charger	___A	_____	\$_____
Inverter	___W PSW	_____	\$_____
Monitor	_____	_____	\$_____
Wiring + fuses	_____	_____	\$_____
TOTAL			\$_____

QUICK CROSS-CHECK

- ☐ Solar watts = 1.5-2x battery Ah?
- ☐ Controller amps = ~1/3 of solar watts?
- ☐ Inverter = 2-3x biggest 240V appliance?
- ☐ All three pass? System is balanced. Go buy it.

Shopping List

My tier: _____

Budget range: \$_____

Battery

_____ Ah lithium (LiFePO4)

Must have built-in BMS. Check dimensions fit battery box.

Brand:

Price: \$

Solar (Fixed)

_____ W total (___ panels x ___ W)

Monocrystalline. Check physical size fits roof.

Brand:

Price: \$

Solar (Portable)

_____ W folding panel

Check it comes with Anderson plug connector.

Brand:

Price: \$

Charge Controller

_____ A MPPT

Check max input voltage matches panel config.

Brand:

Price: \$

DC-DC Charger

_____ A

Check compatibility with vehicle alternator.

Brand:

Price: \$

Inverter

_____ W pure sine wave

Must be PSW. Check outlet types (GPO, USB).

Brand:

Price: \$

Battery Monitor

Shunt-based with Bluetooth

Brand:

Price: \$

Wiring and Accessories

Item	Spec	Qty	Price
Battery cable (pos)	___ mm ²	___ m	\$_____
Battery cable (neg)	___ mm ²	___ m	\$_____
Solar cable	4mm ² twin	___ m	\$_____
Anderson plugs (50A)	Standard	___ pairs	\$_____
Ext. Anderson socket	Weatherproof	1	\$_____
Bus bars (+/-)	Rated for system	2	\$_____
ANL fuse + holder	Rated for battery	1	\$_____
Blade fuses (assorted)	Fuse box or individual	___	\$_____
MC4 connectors	For solar panels	___ pairs	\$_____
Cable ties + clips	Assorted	1 pack	\$_____
Mounting brackets	For panels	___ sets	\$_____

Total Budget

Category	Estimated Cost
Battery	\$_____
Solar (fixed + portable)	\$_____
Charge controller	\$_____
DC-DC charger	\$_____
Inverter	\$_____
Battery monitor	\$_____
Wiring + accessories	\$_____
Total components	\$_____
Installation (if applicable)	\$_____
GRAND TOTAL	\$_____

Use the Before You Buy checklist to make sure you haven't missed anything.

You're all set.

You've got your tier, your shopping list, and your checklists. Everything you need to get solar on your caravan without second-guessing yourself.

YOUR RESOURCES

- **Power Audit Worksheet**
Work out your daily watt-hours
 - **System Sizing Worksheet**
Size every component to your usage
 - **Shopping List Worksheet**
Track brands, specs, and costs
 - **Before You Buy Checklist**
Final check before you spend
 - **Installer Brief**
Hand this to your installer
 - **First Week Checklist**
Get comfortable with your system
-

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1. Complete your Power Audit worksheet
2. Identify your tier (Weekender, Tourer, Full-timer)
3. Fill in your Shopping List from Section 4
4. Run through the Before You Buy checklist
5. Hand your installer the Installer Brief, or order online